

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

Shortly before the pandemic hit, a request for some maintenance on the floor of our rented home was met, to our shock, with the announcement that our landlords had sought financial advice and decided to sell the property. For many landlords, unfortunately, the homes that they own are seen purely as a financial investment, and disruption to tenants' lives is collateral damage that is barely worth a second thought – of course #notalllandlords etc. But lots of them. The experience of trying to arrange a house move on the morning of the first, terrifying nationwide lockdown is not one that will leave me any time soon, and it made me determined to channel as much of my energy as possible into creating a more secure housing situation for myself, my husband and our two young sons. We already had our next financial goal lined up before we had even finished paying off our debt, but having overcome such a huge hurdle already, and having worked through the challenges that we've covered in the previous steps, it felt more achievable, even if we were going to have to be patient and work hard. I have found saving for a home to be quite unique, both in terms of the actual logistics, and also in an emotional sense too. Saving should always feel like a positive act, but in saving for a house, I can almost visualize the building forming, brick by brick, every time we make another transfer into our savings account.

If you are on the same journey with regard to home-ownership, or hope to be at some point in the future, it's a really good idea to start scoping out your options, and seeing if any